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INVESTOR BRIEF · THE BUSINESS CASE

Faster car-loan decisions, at a cost per file a lender can plan around

cercit drafts the credit appraisal for new-car loans; the lender's own policy decides. This brief covers who pays, how much, and when it turns a profit.

November 2026 · Early stage · Product built and tested on synthetic data · No lender revenue yet

THE COST TODAY

Every car-loan file is built by hand, and lenders pay for it in people and lost customers

25–40

credit memos an officer builds by hand each working day, re-typing bureau, bank and salary data

₹95

officer cost per file, at ₹7 lakh a year and about 7,500 files a year (our assumption)

Days

of waiting while documents go back and forth; some buyers go to another lender

The salary is the smaller cost. The bigger ones are slow decisions, two officers reading one file two ways, and reasons pieced together for the auditor later.

WHAT A LENDER GETS

Four things a credit head can take to the board

Decisions in minutes, not days

Documents are read and cross-checked as they arrive. Clean files go straight to approval.

One policy, applied the same way

The lender’s own rules run on every file. The credit head proposes changes; an admin approves them.

An audit trail that can’t be edited

Each decision records its policy version and reasons. The log is hash-chained and copied to locked storage nightly.

Officers on exceptions only

The same team handles more files and spends its time on the cases that need judgement.

MARKET SIZE · NEW CARS ONLY

₹82 crore a year in our first segment alone

TAM · TOTAL MARKET

Every new-car loan in India

55.7 lakh files · ₹3.2 lakh crore of loans

₹139 cr
fees a year

SAM · OUR SEGMENT

Salaried borrowers

32.7 lakh files · ₹1.9 lakh crore of loans

₹82 cr
fees a year

SOM · 3-YEAR TARGET

4 mid-size lenders

72,000 files · ₹4,100 cr of loans

₹1.8 cr
fees a year

Files × ₹250 a file · 46.4 lakh cars sold in FY26, 80% on a loan, 1.5 applications per loan · used cars, CVs and 3Ws not counted yet

Investor brief · 04 · SIAM FY26; Business Today Apr 2026; CRIF Q1 FY27; HSIE Jul 2022. Fee and applications per loan are assumptions.

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WHO BUYS

Mid-size lenders that finance cars but don’t build their own systems

Vehicle NBFCs

Car loans are core business, decisions by branch officers, and pressure to decide faster than banks.

Small finance banks

Growing retail books, small technology teams, strict audit and RBI reporting needs.

Co-operative banks

Lending to salaried members, mostly on manual files, with no budget for a custom build.

Large private and public banks build in-house, so they are **not** our first buyers. That is why the 3-year target is four lenders, not a share of the whole market.

HOW CERCIT EARNS

A fixed fee that covers our running cost, plus a fee on every file

Platform fee

₹50,000

per lender, per month

Per file

₹150

for each appraisal drafted

Onboarding

₹3 lakh

once, to set up the lender's policy

One lender at 1,500 applications a month pays ₹6 lakh platform + ₹27 lakh in file fees = **₹33 lakh a year**, plus ₹3 lakh once.

WHAT IT COSTS US

About ₹80 a file to run, plus ₹99 lakh a year to keep the lights on

Per file · ~₹80

Item	Cost
Reading salary slips and Form 16	₹34
Reading the bank statement	₹16
PAN and masked Aadhaar	₹14
Face match, servers, storage	₹1
Re-uploads and retries (+20%)	₹15

Fixed, 4 lenders · ₹99 lakh/yr

Item	₹ lakh
2 engineers, on call	40
Support, half a product owner	20
Database and cloud	14
Security testing and audit	12
Production build, over 3 years	13

Investor brief · 07 · AWS Textract and Rekognition list prices at ₹88/$; fixed costs are assumptions. Bureau and AA pulls are paid by the lender.

EARNINGS AT SCALE

A loss at four lenders, profitable from about six, 41% margin at forty

Lenders	Files a year	Revenue	Cost	Profit	Margin
4	72,000	₹1.32 cr	₹1.57 cr	−₹25 lakh	−19% loss
15	3 lakh	₹5.4 cr	₹3.9 cr	₹1.5 cr	28%
40	**10 lakh**	**₹17.4 cr**	**₹10.2 cr**	**₹7.2 cr**	**41%**

Each lender adds ₹18.6 lakh a year after per-file costs: ₹6 lakh platform fee + 18,000 files × ₹70.

Break-even ≈ 6 lenders: ₹99 lakh fixed cost ÷ ₹18.6 lakh per lender.

Investor brief · 08 · Projection: ₹50,000/month + ₹150/file, 1,500 applications per lender a month. Onboarding fees left out. Not audited.

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THE ASK

₹2 crore buys 18 months: enough to reach about six paying lenders

₹40 lakh

once, months 1–3: live bureau and AA links, lender sign-in, security hardening

₹1.49 cr

18 months of running cost at ₹99 lakh a year: team, cloud, security audit

₹11 lakh

buffer for a slower pilot or a longer sales cycle

₹2 crore for 16% equity

₹12.5 crore post-money · pre-seed

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RISKS

What could go wrong, and what we do about it

Risk	How we handle it
₹150 a file is more than the ₹95 officer cost	Sell on speed, consistency, fraud caught and the per-file tools it replaces; the pilot measures it
Lenders are slow to buy	Start with NBFCs and small banks; pilot on a slice of files, not the whole book
RBI digital lending and DPDP rules	Consent records, reasons on every decision, a locked audit trail and erasure on request are built in
Tested only on synthetic data	First pilot runs in shadow mode: cercit scores, the officer decides, results compared
One founder	Hire two engineers from the raise; the policy engine and documentation make hand-over easier

WHERE WE ARE AND THE NEXT 12 MONTHS

Built and working; next comes the first lender

Done

Working product

Customer journey, officer console, policy engine, risk model, audit trail; tested on synthetic files

Months 1–3

Production-grade

Live bureau and AA links, lender sign-in, security audit

Months 4–6

First pilot

One lender in shadow mode; measure time saved and decision match

Months 7–12

Paying lenders

Two to four lenders live; then CVs, 3Ws and self-employed

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If you see a business here, let’s talk

cercit is built by Sameer Shreenivas Mittimani, from years of hands-on work in vehicle finance.

LinkedIn
linkedin.com/in/sameersm

Email
samsm@outlook.in

Live demo
cercit.github.io/CERCIT_autoloan